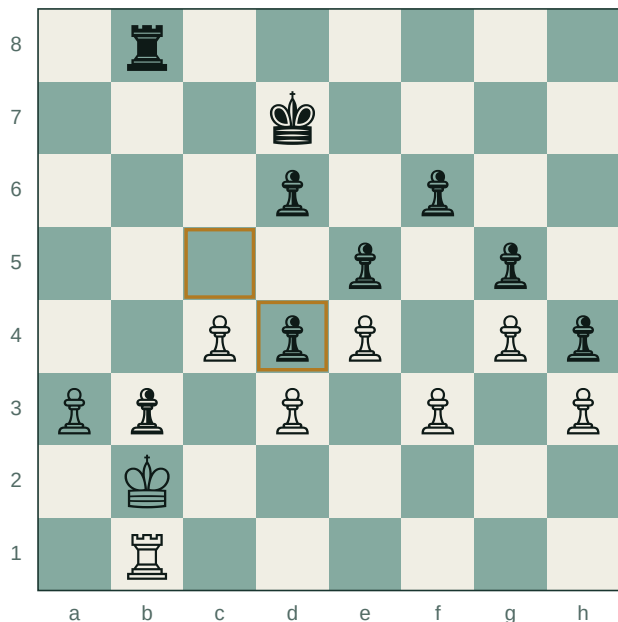


Quiet tactical moves: White, move 43

Quiet tactical moves

White to move



Previous move: 42...cxd4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

43. a4 Rb7 44. Ka3

43.a4 The pawn moves from a3 to a4. Recorded reply: **43...Rb7**.

44.Ka3 The king moves from b2 to a3.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 12 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on d7. Geometrically undefended: rook on b8. Check for tactical protection.